

Udyoga Pramoda

Designing a Mentor-Gated Progression System to Structure a Volunteer-Driven Career Platform

Hero Section

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Udyoga Pramoda is a community-led career initiative where senior professionals mentor early-career aspirants through workshops, resume reviews, and interview preparation.

As participation scaled beyond 150 aspirants, readiness validation existed informally but lacked structured visibility. Placements were happening, yet progression was not measurable.

This project focused on structuring informal mentor-driven progression into a scalable, trackable system—without increasing mentor burden.

Context

As the initiative grew, mentor validation lived in WhatsApp threads. There was no centralized aspirant tracking, no stage-wise funnel visibility, and placement outcomes were anecdotal.

The system functioned culturally but governance became fragile at scale. This was an operational governance and scalability problem rather than a pure interface issue.

Core Product Challenge

How might we introduce structured progression and readiness visibility in a volunteer-driven ecosystem without increasing mentor workload?

Key Insight

Out of 150 aspirants, 50 completed mentor-assigned skill tasks and were validated as job-ready.

25+ secured placements within 3 months, representing ~50% conversion from validated aspirants.

The primary bottleneck was readiness conversion (150 to 50), not placement matching.

Mentor-Gated Progression

Mentor-gated progression ensures aspirants advance only after mentor validation, making readiness reflect demonstrated capability rather than self-reporting.

Mentors already controlled progression informally. The platform structured and surfaced that control through visible state transitions.

Information Architecture

[Insert IA Diagram Here]

System Architecture

[Insert Progression Flow Diagram Here]

High-Fidelity UI – Aspirant Dashboard

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High-Fidelity UI – Mentor View

[Insert Screen Here]

High-Fidelity UI – Admin Dashboard

[Insert Screen Here]

High-Fidelity UI – Validation State

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Outcomes

150 aspirants onboarded.

50 mentor-validated as job-ready (33%).

25+ secured placements (~50% conversion from validated aspirants).

Average salary approximately ■7.5 LPA.

Reduced coordination ambiguity and improved readiness-to-placement visibility.

Reflection

The core value of this project was structuring informal mentor-driven progression into a measurable governance model while preserving volunteer capacity.

Future iterations would focus on improving readiness conversion without increasing mentor burden.